

PROPOSAL FOR HIV/AIDS AND COVID-19 AWARENESS PROGRAMME FOR
DESIGN AND BUILD FOR MODERNIZATION OF THE MALINDI WHARF AREA AT
DAR ES SALAAM PORT.



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0.0 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Government of Tanzania, through the Tanzania Ports Authority (TPA), is upgrading the Malindi Wharf at the Port of Dar es Salaam to enhance cargo handling capacity and operational efficiency. As the country's main seaport and a key regional trade gateway for several landlocked countries, the port plays a significant role in East Africa's economy. The project includes construction of a multipurpose berth and supporting infrastructure such as access roads, operational yards, utilities, and improved port systems, under a Design and Build contract led by China Harbour Engineering Company Ltd.

Large construction projects pose public health risks, particularly the spread of HIV/AIDS and COVID-19 due to workforce mobility and limited access to health services. Given Tanzania's HIV burden, targeted workplace interventions are essential to protect workers, surrounding communities, and overall productivity.

In response to these challenges, Vision Care Clinic proposes to implement a comprehensive HIV/AIDS and COVID-19 awareness and prevention programme tailored specifically for personnel engaged in the Malindi Wharf modernization project. The programme will focus on enhancing awareness, promoting safe practices, facilitating access to testing and counselling services, and strengthening linkages to treatment and care.

The programme also fulfills legal and contractual requirements under national laws and international standards, while ensuring strict confidentiality of health information in line with the HIV and AIDS (Prevention and Control) Act.



1.0 INTRODUCTION

Globally, about 40.8 million people were living with HIV by 2024, with Tanzania accounting for approximately 1.6 million cases and a national prevalence of 4.4%. Although new infections have declined, HIV transmission remains influenced by factors such as demographic differences, socio-economic conditions, and high-risk groups including mobile populations like construction workers.

Construction settings increase vulnerability to HIV and COVID-19 due to worker mobility, social interaction, and separation from families. Workplace awareness programs are therefore essential to reduce transmission, promote safe behaviors, encourage voluntary testing, and minimize stigma, while also maintaining productivity and reducing workforce turnover. These interventions contribute to national efforts aimed at lowering new infections and improving community health outcomes.

The Malindi Wharf modernization project, implemented by the Tanzania Ports Authority on behalf of the Government of Tanzania, is being executed by China Harbour Engineering Company Ltd under a Design and Build contract. The project includes development of a multipurpose berth and supporting infrastructure such as yards, roads, utilities, and drainage systems, all aimed at improving port efficiency and strengthening its role as a key regional trade hub.

In response, Vision Care Clinic proposes a targeted HIV/AIDS awareness and prevention program for project workers, focusing on education, risk reduction, testing, and linkage to care services to support a healthier and safer working environment.

Vision and Care Clinic proposes a comprehensive HIV/AIDS Awareness and Prevention Training Program for employees working in the construction industry. Construction workers often work in environments that expose them to higher health risks due to mobility, long working hours, and limited access to health education.

This program aims to improve awareness, encourage safe behaviors, promote HIV testing, and reduce stigma within the workplace.

1.1 TRAINING OBJECTIVES

The following are the objectives of the HIV/AIDS and COVID 19 awareness program:

- Increase Knowledge about HIV/AIDS and Capacity Building for Preventive measures.
- Promote Safe Behaviors and Risk Reduction
- Strengthen Access to Prevention and Health Services
- Integrate Health and Safety into Workplace Operations
- Reduce Stigma, Discrimination, and Improve Workplace Welfare
- Enhance Monitoring, Evaluation, and Continuous Improvement



1.2 TARGET PARTICIPANTS

The training program will target:

- Construction workers
- Site supervisors
- Administrative staff
- Safety officers

2.0 TRAINING METHODOLOGY

The training will use participatory and interactive learning approaches including:

- Interactive workshops
- Group discussions
- Practical demonstrations (e.g., correct condom use)
- Educational videos
- Question and answer sessions
- Distribution of educational materials
- Guidance on Voluntary Counselling and Testing (VCT)

3.0 SIX-MONTH TRAINING PLAN

The following is the plan for the six month awareness program concerning HIV/AIDS and COVID 19 issues in the Malindi Wharf modernization project.

Table 1: Description of the Training Plan

Sn	Month	Activities
1.	Month 1	• Basic understanding of HIV and AIDS • Hold introductory sensitization meeting on HIV/AIDS and prevention measures
2.	Month 2	• Organize HIV/AIDS awareness training sessions for workers and staff • Train peer educators on basic counseling and prevention messaging • Distribute IEC materials (posters, brochures) on HIV prevention
3.	Month 3	• Conduct behavior change communication (BCC) sessions on safe practices • Organize condom education and correct-use demonstrations • Facilitate peer-to-peer discussions on risk reduction strategies
4.	Month 4	• Arrange voluntary counseling and testing (VCT) campaign at the workplace • Link workers to nearby health facilities for HIV services and support • Conduct referral system awareness sessions for treatment and care



Sn	Month	Activities
		services
5.	Month 5	• Integrate HIV/AIDS and occupational health topics into toolbox talks • Conduct anti-stigma and discrimination awareness campaign • Organize workplace dialogue sessions on employee welfare and inclusion
6.	Month 6	• Conduct end line survey to measure knowledge and behavior change • Review program achievements against baseline results • Hold feedback and lessons learned workshop for improvement planning

4.0 EXPECTED PROVISIONS FOR THE PROGRAM

Vision and Care Clinic will provide:

- Qualified health educators for conducting training
- Monthly training sessions to the community members and workers
- Training materials and handouts such as magazines and notices.
- HIV/AIDS awareness posters for the workplace
- Monitoring and evaluation of the program
- Reports for the conducted activities

5.0 EXPECTED ACHIVEMENTS

By the end of the training program:

- To enhance understanding of HIV/AIDS and COVID-19 transmission, prevention, and control through structured training, awareness campaigns, and peer education.
- To encourage positive behavioral change among workers that reduces exposure to infection and promotes safe practices in both workplace and community settings.
- To improve access to voluntary counselling and testing (VCT), treatment services, and preventive materials such as condoms and personal protective equipment.
- To incorporate HIV/AIDS and COVID-19 preventive measures into daily construction activities, site safety systems, and project management procedures.
- To promote a supportive working environment by reducing stigma, encouraging inclusion, and safeguarding the dignity of affected workers.
- To track implementation effectiveness, evaluate outcomes, and continuously improve program delivery based on feedback and data.



6.0 TRAINING COST

Monthly Training Fee: TZS 1,200,000

Program Duration: 6 Months

Total Program Cost: TZS 7,200,000

7.0 CONCLUSION

Vision Care Clinic is committed to improving community health through education, prevention, and support services. This HIV/AIDS awareness program will help create a safer, healthier, and more informed workplace for construction company employees.

We look forward to working together to promote health and wellbeing in the workplace.

8.0 APPENDICES

APPENDIX I: CONTACTS INFORMATION

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